ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଢଗଢମାଳି

Odia Sayings and Proverbs

108 sayings in Odia and English

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Project Odisha · Reading edition

ଢଗଢମାଳି ବିଷୟରେ

About this collection

ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଢଗଢମାଳି ଚିହ୍ନା ଚିତ୍ର, ଛନ୍ଦ ଓ ଥଟ୍ଟାରେ ଦୈନନ୍ଦିନ ଜୀବନର କଥାକୁ ମନେ ରହିବା ପରି କହେ। ଲେମ୍ବୁ, ମେଘ ବା ଖାଲି ବଟୁଆର କଥା ଦେଇ କେବେ ପରାମର୍ଶ ଦିଆଯାଏ, କେବେ କାହାକୁ ଚିଡ଼ାଯାଏ, କେବେ ତାଙ୍କ ଆଚରଣ ନେଇ ପ୍ରଶ୍ନ କରାଯାଏ। ଏହି ସଂଗ୍ରହରେ ଛନ୍ଦମୟ କଥନ, ପ୍ରବାଦ ଓ ଲକ୍ଷଣାର୍ଥରେ ବ୍ୟବହୃତ ଛୋଟ ଉକ୍ତି ରହିଛି; ସେମାନଙ୍କ ଭିନ୍ନ ରୂପ ଓ ବ୍ୟବହାରର ପ୍ରସଙ୍ଗକୁ ମଧ୍ୟ ଧ୍ୟାନ ଦିଆଯାଇଛି।

Odia dhaga–dhamali give everyday observations a memorable shape through familiar images, rhythm and pointed humour. A lemon, a cloud or an empty pouch can become a way to offer advice, tease someone or question their conduct. This collection brings together rhymed sayings, proverbs and figurative expressions, keeping their different forms and the situations in which they make sense in view.

Read by theme or follow the sayings in order. The examples are original illustrations of everyday use.

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Each reading includes the saying, its literal sense, meaning and an original usage example. Source acknowledgements and reuse rights are collected at the end.

Words & appearances · Saying 006

କହି ଦେଉଥାଇ ପରକୁ, ବୁଦ୍ଧି ନ ଦିଶଇ ଘରକୁ

Advice that stops at the doorstep

ଅନ୍ୟକୁ ଉପଦେଶ ଦେଇ ନିଜେ ତାହା ନ ମାନିବା|

Literal meaning

One keeps advising others, but wisdom is not seen at home.

Meaning

The criticism is the gap between giving advice and practising it. The outward-facing adviser appears wise, yet fails to apply that wisdom to their own affairs. The saying invites self-examination; it does not imply that advice is worthless whenever its giver has difficulties.

An example · original

A person lectures everyone about keeping accounts but repeatedly loses track of their own spending. A relative uses this line to point out the inconsistency. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The rhyme of ପରକୁ and ଘରକୁ reinforces the contrast between others and home. Here the structure is part of the saying's force, not just decoration.

Words & appearances · Saying 007

ଗରଜିଲା ମେଘ ବରଷେ ନାହିଁ

Noise is not the same as action

ବଡ଼ ବଡ଼ କଥା କହିବା ଓ କାମ କରିବା ଏକ କଥା ନୁହେଁ।

Literal meaning

The cloud that thunders does not rain.

Meaning

The contrast between loud thunder and absent rain is used to question bluster: impressive promises or threats do not necessarily lead to action. Read the sentence figuratively. Thunderstorms can, of course, bring rain; the proverb is not a dependable weather rule.

An example · original

Someone loudly promises to repair a shared bench, but nothing happens. Others use the saying to ask for action rather than another announcement. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Weather becomes a way of talking about human speech. Similar imagery elsewhere would not by itself prove where this Odia wording originated.



Thunder fills the air; the bowl stays empty. An illustration of noise without results. Original illustration for Project Odisha · CC BY-SA 4.0.

Words & appearances · Saying 013

ଅତି ଭକ୍ତି ଚୋର ଲକ୍ଷଣ |

When praise becomes suspicious

ଅତ୍ୟଧିକ ତୋଷାମୋଦ ପଛରେ ସ୍ୱାର୍ଥ ଲୁଚିଥାଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Excessive devotion is a thief's sign.

Meaning

Exaggerated displays of devotion or deference can invite suspicion that the speaker wants something. In everyday use the warning can concern flattery, not only religious devotion. The force comes from the deliberately sharp word "thief"; the saying itself is not evidence that a particular admirer is dishonest.

An example · original

A stranger showers a shopkeeper with praise and then asks to take goods away without paying. The shopkeeper recalls this saying and checks the request carefully. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

ଭକ୍ତି supplies the outward appearance of reverence, while ଚୋର supplies the hidden motive in the proverb's contrast. Interpretation depends on the conversation; sincere devotion is not being classified as theft.

Words & appearances · Saying 020

କାଚ, କାଚ, ମଣି, ମଣି, କିଣା ବିକା ବେଳେ ଜଣା ଜଣି

Value put to the test

ପରୀକ୍ଷା ବେଳେ ଅସଲ ମୂଲ୍ୟ ଜଣାପଡ଼େ|

Literal meaning

Glass is glass, a gem is a gem; buying and selling reveal which is which.

Meaning

Resemblance and confident claims are not enough to establish value. The saying imagines a transaction as the moment when differences become consequential. It can be used when an attractive promise finally has to face a practical test.

An example · original

Two suppliers make equally impressive promises; a buyer asks to see their finished work before deciding. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The image comes from comparing valuable objects with lookalikes. It is a metaphor about testing claims, not a guarantee that markets always recognise quality.

Words & appearances · Saying 025

ଏଣ୍ଡୁଅପରି ମୁଣ୍ଡ ଟୁଙ୍ଗାରିବା

Nodding without understanding

କଥା ବୁଝିବା ନ ବୁଝିବା ନିର୍ବିଶେଷରେ ଖାଲି ମୁଣ୍ଡ ହଲାଇ ସମ୍ମତି ଦେବା|

Literal meaning

Nod the head like a lizard.

Meaning

A person keeps signalling agreement whether or not they understand what is being said. The source's gloss makes the gap between the nod and comprehension explicit. The expression can tease empty assent or call attention to it when a real decision requires understanding.

An example · original

After a complicated explanation, a listener nods along but cannot say what they have agreed to do. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The animal comparison belongs to the figurative expression. The entry makes no zoological claim about why a lizard moves its head.

Words & appearances · Saying 028

ଅଙ୍ଗୁଳି ସନ୍ଧିରେ ମଳି ଭିତରେ ଭିତରେ ସଲା ସୁତୁରାଲୋ ଉପରେ ଉପରେ କଳି |

A quarrel staged for others

ଭିତରେ ମିଳାମିଶା ରଖି ବାହାରେ ଲୋକଦେଖାଣିଆ କଳି କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Dirt between the fingers; agreement behind the scenes, quarrelling on the surface.

Meaning

Two sides appear to fight while privately cooperating. The repeated contrast between inside and outside exposes a performance meant to mislead an audience. The saying accuses the quarrel of being staged; it does not merely describe people who disagree but remain friendly.

An example · original

Two organisers loudly blame each other in public, although they have already agreed privately to divide the benefit. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The three source lines are retained. The address particle ଲୋ adds a conversational voice; the English rendering conveys the contrast without inventing a named listener.

Words & appearances · Saying 037

ଲୁଚିଛି ନା ଗୋଡ ଦିଇଟା ଦିଶୁଛି!

A hiding place that gives you away

ଲୁଚାଇବାକୁ ଚେଷ୍ଟା କଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ କୌଣସି ଚିହ୍ନରୁ କଥାଟି ସ୍ପଷ୍ଟ ଜଣାପଡ଼ିଯିବା|

Literal meaning

Are you hiding? Your two feet are showing!

Meaning

Someone’s attempt to conceal a matter leaves an obvious clue. The question punctures the pretence of secrecy: what is meant to be hidden is still visible. It can tease a transparent excuse without proving any particular accusation.

An example · original

A friend tries to keep a surprise parcel hidden, but its wrapping sticks out of the bag. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The licensed page gives this as an additional expression beneath another saying. It is recorded here in its own wording; the neighbouring saying and its gloss are not treated as identical.

Words & appearances · Saying 043

ଠାକୁର ଘରେ କିଏ ରେ? ନାଁ। ମୁଁ କଦଳୀ ଖାଇନାହିଁ

An answer that reveals too much

କିଏ ଅଛି ବୋଲି ପଚାରିବାରେ କଦଳୀ ଖାଇନାହିଁ ବୋଲି ଉତ୍ତର ଦେବା—ଅନାବଶ୍ୟକ ସଫେଇ ଦେଇ ନିଜ ଉପରକୁ ସନ୍ଦେହ ଆଣିବା|

Literal meaning

Who is in the shrine room? Well, I have not eaten the bananas.

Meaning

The question asks who is there, but the answer denies an act nobody mentioned. That unsolicited detail directs attention to the speaker’s possible concern. The humour comes from the mismatch between question and reply; a defensive answer alone does not establish guilt.

An example · original

Asked who used the desk, someone immediately replies that they did not break the pen. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary quotes this dialogue under the connective use of na and explicitly calls it a dhaga. The shrine room and bananas belong to the saying; no actual theft, temple custom or origin story is asserted.

Words & appearances · Saying 046

କଂସାରୀ ଘର ପାରାଙ୍କୁ କୁଲା ଢାଉଁ ଢାଉଁ

A noise that does not impress

ଯିଏ ପୂର୍ବରୁ ସେହିପରି ପରିସ୍ଥିତିରେ ଅଭ୍ୟସ୍ତ, ତାକୁ ସାମାନ୍ୟ ଧମକ ବା ଆଡ଼ମ୍ବର ଦେଖାଇ ପ୍ରଭାବିତ କରିବାର ଚେଷ୍ଟା।

Literal meaning

To the bell-metal worker’s household pigeons: bang, bang with a winnowing tray!

Meaning

An attempt to startle or impress has little effect on someone already accustomed to the disturbance. The joke contrasts the small display of noise with the noisy workshop imagined around the birds. It can describe an empty threat made to an experienced listener.

An example · original

A seasoned performer remains calm when someone tries to unsettle them with a little backstage commotion. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The workshop and winnowing tray form the saying’s acoustic image. Kansari is translated through the craft role in this expression; it does not establish the identity of any present maker or an inherited community trait.

Words & appearances · Saying 049

ତିଳକୁ ତାଳ କରିବା

Making a small thing enormous

ଛୋଟ କଥାକୁ ବଢ଼ାଇଚଢ଼ାଇ ବଡ଼ କରି କହିବା| ସାମାନ୍ୟ ଭୁଲ ବା ଅସୁବିଧାକୁ ତାହାର ପ୍ରକୃତ ଆକାରଠାରୁ ବହୁତ ବଡ଼ କରି ଦେଖାଇଲେ ଏହି କଥା କୁହାଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

To make a palmyra fruit out of a sesame seed.

Meaning

A tiny seed is imagined as something much larger. The expression calls out exaggeration: a small mistake, slight or difficulty has been enlarged beyond proportion. Its force is a brisk objection to the scale of the telling, rather than a claim that the original problem did not exist.

An example · original

A message arrives a few minutes late, but its recipient retells the delay as though the entire gathering nearly failed. A friend asks them not to make so much of it. (Original editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The compact sound-pair ତିଳ and ତାଳ carries the jump in scale. The English rendering takes ତାଳ as the palmyra fruit; the short witness does not spell out that referent, so this lexical choice remains for fluent-reader review. The explanation should not be used to dismiss another person's distress without understanding it.

Words & appearances · Saying 055

ତୁଛାକୁ ଏତେ ନା ମୁଦି ନାହିଁ ଗୋଡ଼ କଛାଡୁ କେତେ |

All that stamping over nothing

ଦେଖାଇବାକୁ କିଛି ନଥିଲେ ବି ଅଯଥାରେ ଏତେ ଅଥୟ ହେବା ବା ଆଡ଼ମ୍ବର କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Such a fuss over nothing: no ring, yet so much stamping of the feet.

Meaning

An exaggerated display outruns what there is to display. The source gloss connects it with being agitated over nothing.

An example · original

A group celebrates a project so loudly that nobody notices it has not yet begun. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The witness does not specify the ring’s position or supply a story behind the image.

Words & appearances · Saying 058

ଚୋର ମା ଯଦି କାନ୍ଦେ ଆଖି ମଳିମଳି କାନ୍ଦେ |

Tears that conceal support

ବାହାରକୁ ଦୁଃଖ ଦେଖାଇଲେ ବି ଭିତରେ ଭୁଲ କରିଥିବା ଲୋକକୁ ସମର୍ଥନ କରିବାକୁ ଏହି କଥା ଇଙ୍ଗିତ କରେ|

Literal meaning

If the thief’s mother cries, she cries rubbing her eyes.

Meaning

The source reads the display of distress as concealed support for a wrongdoer. The charge is complicity behind appearances, not proof that a crying relative is guilty.

An example · original

Someone publicly deplores a friend’s deception while privately helping conceal it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The maternal figure belongs to the saying; responsibility cannot be inferred from kinship or tears alone.

Words & appearances · Saying 060

ଅଲାଜୁକ ଷାଠିଆ ପାନ ନାହିଁ ଗୁଆ ନାହିଁ ଖାଲି ବଟୁଆ!

An impressive pouch with nothing inside

ଭିତରେ କିଛି ନଥିଲେ ବି ବାହାରକୁ ବଡ଼ ଆଡ଼ମ୍ବର ଦେଖାଇବା|

Literal meaning

A shameless show-off: no betel leaf, no areca nut, only an empty pouch!

Meaning

The accessory promises substance that is absent. The source gloss identifies shameless outward boasting.

An example · original

A lavish brochure advertises a service that nobody can actually provide. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The betel pouch supplies the contrast. “Show-off” renders the source’s overall sense; the colloquial opening is not independently glossed word by word.



Original Pattachitra-inspired modern interpretation for Project Odisha; not archival or attributed to a traditional artist. The plate of leaves and nuts is a set of reference objects outside the pouch, not its contents; the pouch remains empty. CC BY-SA4.0.

Words & appearances · Saying 064

ଶୁଣ୍ଡି ସାକ୍ଷୀ ମାତାଲ!

A witness with a stake in the story

ଯାହାଙ୍କ ସପକ୍ଷରେ ସାକ୍ଷୀ ଦିଆଯାଉଛି, ସାକ୍ଷୀଙ୍କର ତାଙ୍କ ସହ ସ୍ୱାର୍ଥ ଜଡ଼ିତ; ତେଣୁ ନିରପେକ୍ଷତା ନେଇ ପ୍ରଶ୍ନ ଉଠେ।

Literal meaning

The liquor seller's witness is the drunk!

Meaning

The supposed witness has a connection to the person being defended. The pointed question is whether that testimony is independent.

An example · original

A seller cites only their business partner as proof of a product's quality. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The occupational caricature is not evidence about any community's honesty. Shared interests invite scrutiny, not automatic disbelief.

Words & appearances · Saying 083

କହି ଜାଣିଲେ କଥା ସୁନ୍ଦର ବାନ୍ଧି ଜାଣିଲେ ମଥା ସୁନ୍ଦର

The art of saying it well

କଥା କହିବାର ଢଙ୍ଗ ଜାଣିଲେ କଥା ଭଲ ଲାଗେ; କେଶ ସଜାଇବା ଜାଣିଲେ ମଥା ସୁନ୍ଦର ଦିଶେ| ଉଭୟରେ କୌଶଳର ମୂଲ୍ୟ ଅଛି|

Literal meaning

Know how to speak, and words are beautiful; know how to arrange hair, and the head is beautiful.

Meaning

How something is done matters. Well-chosen words are compared with hair arranged by a practised hand.

An example · original

A colleague makes a difficult request gently and clearly, helping everyone respond. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this under arranging hair and labels it ଢଗ଼ଡ଼The comparison concerns skill, not a rule about personal appearance.

Words & appearances · Saying 085

ଦିନକର ଭାତ ଯୁଗକର କଥା

A meal ends; its reputation remains

ଭୋଜନ ଦିନକର, କିନ୍ତୁ ସେହି ଅବସରର ଭଲମନ୍ଦ ନାମ ବହୁଦିନ ରହିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

One day’s rice; ages of reputation.

Meaning

A brief occasion can leave a lasting impression, good or bad. Its memory outlasts the meal.

An example · original

Guests remember a host’s considerate welcome long after the gathering ends. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places କଥା here under fame or notoriety and labels the saying ପ୍ରବଚନ—No particular feast is identified.

Words & appearances · Saying 087

କଥା କହୁଥାଏ କେଉଁ ରସରେ, ମୋତେ ଲାଗୁଥାଏ ପରିହାସରେ

That sounds like mockery to me

କହୁଥିବା ଲୋକର ଭାବ ଯାହା ହେଉ, ଶୁଣୁଥିବା ଲୋକକୁ କଥାଟି ପରିହାସ ପରି ଲାଗୁଛି|

Literal meaning

Whatever the manner of the speech, it feels like mockery to me.

Meaning

A listener hears ridicule, whatever the speaker intended. The contrast draws attention to how words are received.

An example · original

A playful remark lands badly with someone already upset. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary gives this under manner and a related wording under intention. No particular speaker or quarrel is identified.

Words & appearances · Saying 098

ଚମବାଇଦ କୋଶେ, ତୁଣ୍ଡ ବାଇଦ ଶହସ୍ର କୋଶ

Words travel farther than drums

ଢୋଲର ଶବ୍ଦ ଯେତେ ଦୂର ଯାଏ, ଲୋକମୁଖରେ ଚାଲୁଥିବା କଥା ତାଠାରୁ ବହୁ ଦୂର ପହଞ୍ଚେ। ହଜାର କୋଶ କଥାଟି ଏଠାରେ ଅତିଶୟୋକ୍ତି।

Literal meaning

A hide-drum carries one kos; the mouth's drum a thousand kos.

Meaning

News passed from person to person can spread much farther than a sound heard at its source. The contrast is deliberate exaggeration, not a measured claim about distance.

An example · original

A small announcement at a village gathering is being discussed in distant households the next day. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary's sense1 is a report or rumour carried by word of mouth. The longer witness is retained; the discovery list gives only its latter idea.

Words & appearances · Saying 102

ବିରାଡ଼ି ବଇଷମ

A pious appearance that deceives

ବାହାରେ ଧାର୍ମିକ ବେଶ ଦେଖାଇ ଭିତରେ ତାହାର ବିପରୀତ କାମ କରିବା| ଏହା କପଟ ଆଚରଣର ସମାଲୋଚନା, କୌଣସି ଧର୍ମର ସମସ୍ତ ଲୋକଙ୍କ ବିଷୟରେ ଦାବି ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

A cat as a Vaishnava devotee.

Meaning

A show of devotion conceals conduct that contradicts it. The target is the mismatch between appearance and action, not believers as a group.

An example · original

A fictional official advertises personal virtue while secretly taking unfair benefits. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The exact dictionary spelling ବଇଷମ is preserved. It is given as a figurative synonym under ଭେଖଧାରୀ ବୈଷ୍ଣବ୍ଏ no animal fable or historical founder is supplied.

Words & appearances · Saying 108

ମୌନଂ ସମ୍ମତିଲକ୍ଷଣଂ

When silence is read as agreement

ଚୁପ୍ ରହିବାକୁ ସମ୍ମତିର ଚିହ୍ନ ବୋଲି ଧରାଯାଉଥିବା ଧାରଣାକୁ ଏହି କଥାଟି କହେ| କିନ୍ତୁ ଭୟ, ଦ୍ୱିଧା ବା ଅନିଶ୍ଚୟରେ ବି ମଣିଷ ଚୁପ୍ ରହିପାରେ; ସମ୍ମତି ନିଶ୍ଚିତ କରିବାକୁ ସ୍ପଷ୍ଟ ଉତ୍ତର ଦରକାର|

Literal meaning

Silence is a sign of agreement.

Meaning

This maxim describes an inference people make from another person's silence. Silence can also mean hesitation, fear or uncertainty, so it does not establish that someone has agreed.

An example · original

A chair assumes the quiet room approves a plan; a participant asks for an explicit response from everyone. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary identifies a Sanskrit maxim. It is documented here as an expression to examine, not permission to treat silence as consent.

Judgment & choices · Saying 002

ଆ ବଳଦ ମୋତେ ବିନ୍ଧ |

Inviting trouble

ନିଜେ ଡାକି ଅଯଥା ବିପଦରେ ପଡ଼ିବା|

Literal meaning

Come, ox, gore me.

Meaning

The speaker imagines someone summoning the very trouble they could have avoided. Used ironically, it criticises an unnecessary provocation or a knowingly risky decision. It should not be used to blame someone for harm they did not choose.

An example · original

A person interrupts an argument that has nothing to do with them merely to insult both sides; a friend may use this saying. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

ବଳଦ is rendered here as ox or bullock. The horned animal supplies the force of the image; the wording alone cannot establish a particular village, farming community or date of origin.

Judgment & choices · Saying 014

ଅନ୍ଧାରରେ ବାଡ଼ି ବୁଲାଇବା ।

Swinging without seeing

ଯଥେଷ୍ଟ ତଥ୍ୟ ବା ଦିଗ ନ ଜାଣି ଅନୁମାନରେ କାମ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Swinging a stick in darkness.

Meaning

A stick swung in darkness may miss its intended target because the person cannot see where to aim. The expression describes guesses or effort without adequate information. Its criticism is not that no effort is being made, but that effort has no dependable direction.

An example · original

Several people keep changing settings on a faulty device without checking what has failed. One suggests identifying the problem first instead of trying changes at random. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

This is an idiomatic action phrase rather than a complete rhyming couplet. Darkness is the image for missing information; no specific origin incident has been established.

Judgment & choices · Saying 018

ଆରେ ଏ, ଯେତେବେଳେ ଯେ

Responding to the occasion

ସମୟ ଓ ପରିସ୍ଥିତି ଦେଖି ଉଚିତ କାମ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Hey, you—whatever the occasion calls for.

Meaning

This compressed expression advises a fitting response to the circumstances. It may interrupt someone who insists on handling every situation in the same way. The point is practical judgement about this occasion, rather than a rule that commitments can always be discarded.

An example · original

A host changes the outdoor arrangements when rain begins instead of insisting on the original plan. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source itself supplies an English gloss about appropriate action. The elliptical Odia is retained; the English rendering makes the implied advice explicit.

Judgment & choices · Saying 023

ଆଗ ପଞ୍ଚା, ସବୁ କଞ୍ଚା!

Plans are still untested

ଆଗରୁ ଭାବିଥିବା ଯୋଜନା ଠିକଣା ବେଳେ ବଦଳିଯାଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Planned beforehand, yet all still raw!

Meaning

An advance plan may look settled until circumstances put it to the test. The source explains the line as a warning that earlier arrangements can fall apart at the appointed time. It tempers certainty without making preparation itself pointless.

An example · original

Friends confidently divide festival duties, then discover on the day that several people cannot come. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The digital list numbers the saying12 and its explanation13. Those are one saying with its gloss, not two entries. The raw or unripe image marks something not yet dependable.

Judgment & choices · Saying 036

ନାହିଁ ମାମୁଁ ଠଉଁ କଣା ମାମୁ ଭଲ

Some help rather than none

କିଛି ସହାୟତା ନ ମିଳିବାଠାରୁ ସୀମିତ ସହାୟତା ମିଳିବା ଭଲ| ଏଥିରେ ଥିବା ଦୃଷ୍ଟିଦୋଷର ତୁଳନାକୁ ମଣିଷର ମୂଲ୍ୟ ମାପିବାର ମାନଦଣ୍ଡ କରିବା ଉଚିତ ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

A one-eyed maternal uncle is better than no maternal uncle.

Meaning

The comparison expresses a preference for an imperfect resource over having none. Its family image assumes that an uncle can offer care or assistance. The point can be explained without treating disability as a measure of a person’s worth.

An example · original

A reading group uses a small borrowed room while waiting for a larger meeting space. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The historical-style dictionary explanation connects the maternal uncle with care for a nephew. The disability language is preserved as documented wording and identified as a dated comparison; no universal family practice is asserted.

Judgment & choices · Saying 051

ଆଜ ହୁଁ ଏଡ଼, ପାଣି ପଡିଲେ ହବୁ କେଡ଼

A warning before things grow worse

ଏବେଠୁ ଏତେ ଦୋଷ ଦେଖାଗଲାଣି; ସୁଧାର ନହେଲେ ଆଗକୁ ଆହୁରି ବଢ଼ିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Already this big; how big will you become when watered?

Meaning

An early fault prompts a warning about what unchecked growth could bring. It criticises present behaviour, not a child's unchangeable nature.

An example · original

A tiny committee already imposes needless rules; someone wonders what it will do with greater power. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The water-and-growth image is figurative. The source presents this as a negative warning.

Judgment & choices · Saying 056

ଓଧ ସାଙ୍ଗରେ ବଣଭୁଆ ବାଇ!

Following another into a mistake

ଅନ୍ୟ ଜଣଙ୍କ ବୁଦ୍ଧିରେ ପଡ଼ି ନିଜେ ମଧ୍ୟ ଭୁଲ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

With the otter, the wildcat goes wild!

Meaning

Someone follows another’s lead into a mistake. The animal scene makes imitation look foolish.

An example · original

One colleague starts an ill-judged prank; another joins without thinking through the consequences. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Animal names are general renderings, not precise species identifications or claims about animal behaviour.

Judgment & choices · Saying 065

ଏଣ୍ଡୁଅ ଧାଉଡ଼ି ସିଜୁ ବୁଦାକୁ!

Running only to the familiar bush

ବହୁତ ଧାଁଧପଡ଼ କଲେ ବି ଚିନ୍ତା ସେହି ସୀମିତ ଗଣ୍ଠି ଭିତରେ ରହିଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

The lizard’s dash is to the siju bush!

Meaning

The source uses the short dash to mock a narrow range of thought. Much motion may still lead only to a familiar answer.

An example · original

A planning group holds many meetings but considers only the same old option. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Siju is retained as the plant name. This is a figurative reading, not a zoological claim or a judgment of fixed intelligence.

Judgment & choices · Saying 077

ରଜା ଗୋଜା

Authority without judgment

ପଦବୀ ଥିଲେ ବି ବୁଝିବା ଶକ୍ତି ବା ସୁବିଚାର ନଥିବାକୁ ଏହି ଛୋଟ କଥାଟି ଚିଡ଼ାଏ।

Literal meaning

An obtuse king.

Meaning

A curt, rhyming criticism of a ruler’s awkward understanding. Authority has not brought good judgment.

An example · original

A committee leader dismisses a clear explanation simply because it conflicts with their assumption. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary gloss supplies the sense. This is a proverbial taunt, not a claim about all rulers.

Judgment & choices · Saying 078

ଅବୁଝାମଣା ରଜାକୁ ପାଳବିଣ୍ଡା ମନ୍ତ୍ରୀ

A straw-bundle adviser

ନେତା ବୁଝୁନାହାନ୍ତି, ତାଙ୍କ ପରାମର୍ଶଦାତା ମଧ୍ୟ ଠିକ୍ ବୁଦ୍ଧି ଦେଇପାରୁନାହାନ୍ତି—ଦୁଇଜଣଙ୍କ ଯୋଗରେ ଅସୁବିଧା ବଢ଼େ।

Literal meaning

For an uncomprehending king, a bundle-of-straw minister.

Meaning

Poor leadership is compounded by equally foolish advice. The pairing, rather than the ruler alone, is the target.

An example · original

An ill-planned proposal survives because the person asked to assess it understands it no better. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Straw-bundle is a belittling image. The source gloss explicitly describes a foolish adviser to an unjust ruler.

Judgment & choices · Saying 091

ମୂଳୁଁ ମାଇଲେ ଯିବ ସରି, ଦେବଙ୍କ ସଙ୍ଗେ କିପାଁ କଳି

Deal with the root

ମୂଳ କାରଣକୁ ହଟାଇଲେ କଥା ସରିବ—ଏମିତି ଏକ ଅର୍ଥ ଏଠାରୁ ନିଆଯାଇପାରେ। ଏହା ସମ୍ପାଦକୀୟ ବ୍ୟାଖ୍ୟା।

Literal meaning

Destroy it at the root and it will end; why quarrel with the gods?

Meaning

The words contrast ending something at its source with quarrelling. Reading this as a call to address the underlying cause is editorial.

An example · original

Rather than repeatedly arguing over duplicate bookings, a group introduces a shared booking record. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

No originating tale or specific sacred tree is supplied by this dictionary passage. The example does not advocate destruction.

Judgment & choices · Saying 095

କଳେ ବଳେ କୌଶଳେ

By whatever means

ଯେକୌଣସି ଉପାୟରେ କାମ ହାସଲ କରିବା| ପରିସ୍ଥିତି ଅନୁସାରେ ଏଥିରେ ଚେଷ୍ଟାର ଦୃଢ଼ତା ବା ଅନ୍ୟାୟ ଉପାୟର ଇଙ୍ଗିତ ରହିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

By devices, force and skill.

Meaning

The expression describes pursuing a result by every available means. Depending on context, it can suggest determination or a willingness to use unfair methods.

An example · original

A character in a story resolves to win the contest by persuasion, pressure or a clever plan. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

This is an adverbial idiom in the dictionary, not a complete narrative proverb or an endorsement of deceit.

Judgment & choices · Saying 099

ହାତେ ମାପି ଟାଖଣ୍ଡେ ଚାଲିବା

Measure farther than you step

ଆଗକୁ ଭଲଭାବେ ବୁଝି ବିଚାରି ଛୋଟ ପଦକ୍ଷେପ ନେବା| ଯେତିକି କାମ କରିବା, ତାଠାରୁ ଅଧିକ ଦୂରର ଫଳ ଭାବିବା|

Literal meaning

Measure a cubit, then move a span.

Meaning

Examine more of the situation than the immediate step requires. The proverb recommends deliberation before acting; careful preparation can reduce risk without guaranteeing safety.

An example · original

Before moving a workshop, its owners check access, costs and likely demand, then try a small temporary space. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary itself explains the longer measure and shorter step. These are traditional body-based measures; no fixed modern conversion is needed here.

Judgment & choices · Saying 106

ଆକାଶକୁସୁମ

A flower growing in the sky

ଆକାଶରେ ଫୁଲ ଫୁଟିବା ପରି ଅବାସ୍ତବ କଳ୍ପନା| ଶୁଣିବାକୁ ସୁନ୍ଦର ହେଲେ ବି ଯାହାର ବାସ୍ତବ ଭିତ୍ତି ନାହିଁ, ତାହାକୁ ବୁଝାଏ|

Literal meaning

A sky-flower.

Meaning

An attractive idea has no basis in reality, like a flower imagined as growing in empty sky. The expression questions feasibility rather than imagination itself.

An example · original

A proposal promises a large festival without a venue, funds or anyone to organise it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

This is a figurative compound, listed as a synonym under ଖପୁଷ୍ପ।The dictionary establishes the image, not a uniquely Odia origin.



A beautiful flower, with nowhere to take root. A painted interpretation of the metaphor. Original illustration for Project Odisha · CC BY-SA 4.0.

Judgment & choices · Saying 107

ଆଳୁ ଖୋଳୁ ଖୋଳୁ ମହାଦେବ ବାହାରିଲେ

A small search uncovers something larger

ସାଧାରଣ କିଛି ଖୋଜୁ ଖୋଜୁ ଅପ୍ରତ୍ୟାଶିତ ଭାବେ ବଡ଼ କଥା ବାହାରି ପଡ଼ିବା| ଛୋଟ ଖୋଜାରୁ ବଡ଼ ଆବିଷ୍କାର—ଏହି ବିପରୀତତାରେ କଥାଟିର ମଜା|

Literal meaning

While digging for tubers, Mahadeva appeared.

Meaning

An ordinary investigation unexpectedly brings a much larger matter to light. This explanation follows the contrast in scale; the dictionary does not provide an origin tale.

An example · original

Checking one unexplained receipt reveals a much larger error in the accounts. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source labels it ଢଗ under appearing or becoming visible. Mahadeva is Shiva; no particular excavated shrine, village or historical discovery is verified.

Time & seasons · Saying 003

ଏକା ମାଘକେ ଶୀତ ଯାଏନାହିଁ|

There will be another winter

ଆଜିର ଦରକାର ସରିଗଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ଆଗକୁ ପୁଣି ଦରକାର ପଡ଼ିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Cold does not finish with a single Magha.

Meaning

One difficult season is not the last occasion on which we may need help. The saying can warn against treating a temporary advantage as permanent, or remind someone who refuses help that circumstances may change. Tone matters: it can sound like practical advice or a pointed warning.

An example · original

After borrowing a tool successfully once, someone dismisses the neighbour who lent it. Another person reminds them that they may need that neighbour again. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Magha supplies the seasonal image. The central point is recurring need and changing fortunes, not a precise forecast or a claim that cold is confined to one calendar month.

Time & seasons · Saying 008

ବାହାଘର ବେଳେ ବାଇଗଣ ରୁଆ।

Planting when the meal is due

ଦରକାର ବେଳ ଆସିଗଲା ପରେ ପ୍ରସ୍ତୁତି ଆରମ୍ଭ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Planting eggplant at wedding time.

Meaning

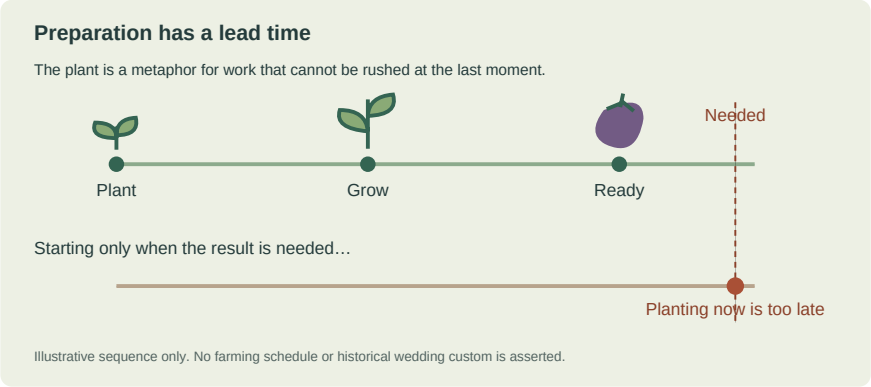
The joke is a mismatch between a long preparation and an immediate need. Planting a crop when the occasion has arrived cannot supply that occasion's meal. The saying criticises starting essential work too late, rather than the act of planting itself.

An example · original

The event starts tomorrow, but the organisers only now begin looking for a venue. Someone compares their timing to planting eggplant at wedding time. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The wedding and vegetable crop create the contrast. This does not prove eggplant is required at every Odia wedding or identify a particular community's menu. The graphic illustrates lead time, not an agricultural timetable.



Original explanatory diagram by Project Odisha, CC BY-SA 4.0; an interpretation of the saying, not a historical illustration.

Time & seasons · Saying 017

ଆଜି କୁରୁ କୁରୁ ହସୁ, କାଲି ଲଙ୍ଗଳ କାହିଁରେ ଚଷୁ ?

Spending tomorrow’s means today

ଆଜିର ଆନନ୍ଦ ପାଇଁ କାଲିର ଜୀବିକାର ସାଧନ ନଷ୍ଟ କରିବା ଉଚିତ ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

Today you laugh merrily; tomorrow, what will you plough with?

Meaning

The teasing question asks what will remain after today’s enjoyment. It warns against consuming the very means needed for tomorrow’s work. The pleasure is immediate, while the cost becomes visible only when work must resume.

An example · original

Someone proposes selling essential work equipment to fund a lavish celebration; a relative answers with this question. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The digital witness supplies a story of burning a plough as feast fuel. Treat that as its illustration of the saying, not a verified event or origin. Its citation currently displays a script error.

Time & seasons · Saying 022

ନଈ ନ ଦେଖୁଣୁ ନଙ୍ଗଳ।

Getting ahead of the occasion

ଆବଶ୍ୟକତା ନିଶ୍ଚିତ ହେବା ଆଗରୁ ଅତି ତତ୍ପର ହେବା|

Literal meaning

Undressed before even seeing the river.

Meaning

The image mocks preparation that runs ahead of any confirmed need. Someone has acted as though the next step were certain before checking whether the situation calls for it. The saying is sharper than a general reminder to plan carefully.

An example · original

Before a trip is agreed, a participant announces the departure date and begins making arrangements for everyone. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The river and undressing belong to the saying's literal scene. They do not establish a particular place, journey or bathing custom as its origin.

Time & seasons · Saying 029

ଏ କଥା ରହିଲା ମନେ, ବେଳ କାଳ ଦେଖି କହିବି ଦିନେ

Saving a reply for later

ଏବେ ଚୁପ୍ ରହିଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ କଥାଟି ମନେ ରଖି ସୁଯୋଗ ବେଳେ ଉତ୍ତର ଦେବା|

Literal meaning

I will keep this in mind; one day I will speak when the time is right.

Meaning

The speaker declines an immediate reply while making clear that the matter is not forgotten. Depending on the situation, the line can sound restrained, pointed or quietly threatening. It preserves a future opportunity to answer rather than offering reconciliation now.

An example · original

Someone is dismissed during a meeting and replies that they will return to the matter when the facts can be discussed. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The time and occasion remain unspecified in the wording. This entry explains its possible conversational tone without assigning it a historical dispute.

Time & seasons · Saying 035

ତୁଳସୀ ଦୁଇ ପତ୍ରରୁ ବାସେ

Early signs

ଆରମ୍ଭରୁ କାହାର କାମରେ ଗୁଣ ବା ସମ୍ଭାବନା ଦେଖାଦେବା| ଏହା ଭବିଷ୍ୟତ ନିଶ୍ଚିତ କରିଦେଉଥିବା ନିୟମ ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

Tulasi gives off its fragrance from its first two leaves.

Meaning

The small plant provides an image for qualities becoming noticeable early. Someone may use the saying when a beginner already shows promise. Early signs can be encouraging without fixing what a child or learner must become.

An example · original

A new student notices a useful pattern in a problem before the lesson has finished. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this clause beside a contrasting plant comparison. Only the tulasi clause is displayed here. This is a figurative reading, not a botanical test or a claim about inherited ability.

Time & seasons · Saying 042

ମୁଲୁରୁ ମାଇପ ନାହିଁ ପୁଅ ନାଁ। ଗୋପାଳ

Naming the child before the family exists

ମୂଳ ବ୍ୟବସ୍ଥା ନ ହେଉଣୁ ତାହା ପରର କଥାକୁ ନିଶ୍ଚିତ ଧରି ଯୋଜନା କରିବା|

Literal meaning

There is no wife to begin with, yet the son is named Gopal.

Meaning

Plans have moved ahead of the conditions needed to carry them out. The family scene makes the missing first step conspicuous: a later detail has been settled while the basic situation is still imaginary. It can mock premature certainty rather than planning itself.

An example · original

A club chooses the colour of its new building before securing any place to build it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The wording uses a blunt term for wife and a familiar personal name. It documents a domestic image, not a rule about marriage, parenthood or a person’s entitlement to either.

Time & seasons · Saying 054

ସେଇ ଘଇତା କଲୁ, ବୟସ ଗଡ଼େଇ ଦେଲୁ!

The same choice after all that delay

ବହୁଦିନ ଗଡ଼ାଇ ଶେଷରେ ସେହି ନିଷ୍ପତ୍ତି ନେଲେ; ଏତେ ବିଳମ୍ବ କରି କଣ ଲାଭ ହେଲା?

Literal meaning

You married that same husband, after letting the years pass!

Meaning

After prolonged delay, the eventual choice is the one available before. The jibe targets the wasted interval.

An example · original

After months of indecision, a club adopts the venue it first considered. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Marriage supplies the wording. It need not be used to pressure anyone into marrying early.

Time & seasons · Saying 074

ଚଷା ହୁଡ଼ିଲେ ବରଷେ, ମଣିଷ ହୁଡିଲେ ପୁରୁଷେ

A year lost and a life affected

ଚାଷର ଭୁଲରେ ଗୋଟିଏ ବର୍ଷର କ୍ଷତି ହୋଇପାରେ; ଜୀବନର ବଡ଼ ଭୁଲର ପ୍ରଭାବ ଦୀର୍ଘକାଳ ରହିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

If the cultivator goes wrong, a year is lost; if a person goes wrong, a lifetime.

Meaning

A seasonal mistake is contrasted with a decision that can shape a life. The warning concerns the scale of consequences, not the impossibility of recovery.

An example · original

Before making a lasting commitment, someone pauses to consider consequences beyond the present season. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The cited sense defines ପୁରୁଷ as lifetime, not generation. ଚଷା is read in the farming image; no caste-wide trait is asserted.

Time & seasons · Saying 081

ମାଘ, ଶୀତ ହୁଏ ବାଘ

When cold becomes a tiger

ମାଘର ଜୋର୍ ଶୀତକୁ ବାଘ ସହ ତୁଳନା କରାଯାଇଛି|

Literal meaning

Magha: the cold becomes a tiger.

Meaning

The tiger makes the cold feel fierce.

An example · original

A chilly morning makes someone reach for another shawl. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

A vivid seasonal image, not a weather forecast.



Winter’s bite takes the shape of a tiger. A painted interpretation, not a literal scene. Original illustration for Project Odisha · CC BY-SA 4.0.

Time & seasons · Saying 082

ମାଘେ ଶୀତ, ମେଘେ ଶୀତ, ଯତ୍ର ବାତ ତତ୍ର ଶୀତ

Where the cold is felt

କେବେ ଶୀତ ଲାଗେ ବୋଲି ପଚାରିଲେ ଏହି ଛନ୍ଦମୟ ଉତ୍ତର ଦିଆଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

Cold in Magha, cold under clouds; wherever wind, there cold.

Meaning

A rhythmic reply names occasions when cold is felt.

An example · original

Someone asks why the afternoon feels chilly; another replies with this saying. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary presents it as a reply. Its Sanskrit phrasing is retained; it is not a universal weather rule.

Time & seasons · Saying 088

ମାରି ମାରି ଗଲା କାଳକ ଆଉ ରହିଗଲା ଫାଳକ

Time slips away

ଏମିତି ସମୟ କାଟୁକାଟୁ ବେଳ ଚାଲିଗଲାଣି; ଯାହା ବାକି ଅଛି ତାହାର କଥା ମନେ ପଡୁଛି|

Literal meaning

Whiling it away, time has gone; a half remains.

Meaning

Time has passed while one was merely getting through it. The remaining half is a rhyming image, not a measured lifespan.

An example · original

After postponing a task repeatedly, someone notices how much of the available time has passed. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this under whiling away time. It does not establish the speaker’s age.

Time & seasons · Saying 101

ଶୁଭସ୍ୟ ଶୀଘ୍ରଂ

Do not delay a good beginning

ଭଲ କାମ କରିବାକୁ ନିଷ୍ପତ୍ତି ହେଲେ ଅକାରଣ ବିଳମ୍ବ ନକରିବା| ତରବର ହୋଇ ବିଚାର ଛାଡ଼ିବା ଏହାର ଅର୍ଥ ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

For what is auspicious, promptly.

Meaning

Once a worthwhile action is decided, avoid needless delay. This is encouragement to begin, not a reason to abandon judgment or preparation.

An example · original

After agreeing to repair the library’s leaking roof, the volunteers arrange the work promptly. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The Odia dictionary explicitly labels this a Sanskrit proverb. It is included as an expression used in Odia, not claimed as uniquely Odia in origin.

Work & learning · Saying 004

କାନ୍ଧରେ ପଡିଲେ ବଜାଇ ଶିଖନ୍ତି

Learning when responsibility arrives

ଦାୟିତ୍ୱ ପଡ଼ିଲେ କାମ କରିବାର ଉପାୟ ଶିଖିହୁଏ|

Literal meaning

When it falls on the shoulder, one learns to play.

Meaning

Taking responsibility can force a beginner to learn the necessary skill. The compressed wording leaves the instrument unnamed; imagining a carried percussion instrument helps explain the metaphor, but does not establish which instrument first inspired it. This is encouragement to learn through doing, not a guarantee that preparation is unnecessary.

An example · original

A first-time organiser worries about arranging a neighbourhood reading session. A more experienced friend uses the saying while offering help with the practical tasks. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The body carrying a burden and the hands learning a performance meet in one image. No historical link to a named musical tradition has been verified.

Work & learning · Saying 005

କୁଟା ଖଣ୍ଡକ ଦିଖଣ୍ଡ ନ କରିବା

Not even a straw broken

ସାମାନ୍ୟ କାମଟିଏ ମଧ୍ୟ ନ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Not to break one piece of straw into two.

Meaning

This expression makes a very small action stand for any contribution at all. Saying that someone has not done even this means they have done no work in the situation being discussed. It is an idiomatic phrase rather than a complete rhymed maxim.

An example · original

Several people clean up after a gathering while one person only gives instructions. Someone complains that the person has not lifted a finger—the comparable English idiom. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Straw provides a small, light object in the verbal image. The comparison with an English idiom explains the sense; it is not a claim of translation, borrowing or shared origin.

Work & learning · Saying 038

ଅନ୍ଧ ଥରେ ବାଡ଼ି ହଜାଏ |

Learning from a lost support

ଏକଥର କ୍ଷତି ସହିବା ପରେ ସେହି ଭୁଲ ପୁଣି ନ କରିବାକୁ ସତର୍କ ହେବା|

Literal meaning

A blind person loses the walking stick once.

Meaning

Losing something relied upon can make a person more careful afterwards. The saying compresses that lesson into the loss of a walking stick. It is a figurative warning about repeating mistakes, not a factual assertion about blind people or a guarantee that a loss happens only once.

An example · original

After losing an unsigned draft, a writer starts saving a dated copy after each session. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The wording uses blindness and a stick as an image of dependence on a support. Explain the image without reducing blind people to helplessness or using it to mock disability.

Work & learning · Saying 039

ଆପଣା ହସ୍ତେ ଜିହ୍ୱା ଛେଦି, କେ ଅଛି ତାର ପ୍ରତିବାଦୀ

A difficulty caused by one’s own act

ନିଜ କାମରୁ ଅସୁବିଧା ହୋଇଥିଲେ ତାହାର ଦାୟିତ୍ୱ ଅନ୍ୟ ଉପରେ ନ ଦେଇ ନିଜେ ସ୍ୱୀକାର କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Having cut your tongue with your own hand, who is there to speak against it?

Meaning

The sharp image points to trouble brought about by one’s own action. It challenges an attempt to shift responsibility elsewhere. It should not be used to assume that every hardship is self-caused or that someone who made a mistake no longer deserves help.

An example · original

A team ignores its own backup plan, then finds that a preventable delay has stopped the work. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The bodily injury is a rhetorical image, not an instruction. The final question is rendered as a challenge to protest; it is not evidence for a historical incident.

Work & learning · Saying 041

ଗୋଦରା ଜୋତେ ଯେତେ ମାଡ଼େ ସେତେ

Work that does not move forward

କାମ କରିଚାଲିଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ନିଜ କାମ ନିଜେ ନଷ୍ଟ କରୁଥିବାରୁ ଆଗକୁ ବଢ଼ି ନ ପାରିବା|

Literal meaning

The swollen-legged person digs; as much as they dig, so much they tread over.

Meaning

The image suggests effort whose result is undone as the work proceeds. It can be used for a task that stays unfinished because each advance is cancelled by another action. Its bodily caricature should be recognized rather than turned into a judgment about disabled people.

An example · original

A document is repeatedly reformatted, and each revision removes changes that the team had already agreed on. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Godara is rendered as the saying's description of swollen legs, without diagnosing a medical condition. The interpretation concerns self-defeating work, not physical capacity or personal worth. The figurative explanation is an editorial interpretation, not a separately verified traditional gloss.

Work & learning · Saying 048

ଢିଙ୍କି ସ୍ୱର୍ଗକୁ ଗଲେ ବି ଧାନ କୁଟିବ

The same work, even in heaven

ଢିଙ୍କି ସ୍ୱର୍ଗକୁ ଗଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ତାହାର କାମ ଧାନ କୁଟିବା। ସ୍ଥାନ ବଦଳିଲେ ବି ପୁରୁଣା ଅଭ୍ୟାସ ବା କାମରେ ପରିବର୍ତ୍ତନ ନ ଆସିବାକୁ ଏହି କଥାରେ ଥଟ୍ଟା କରାଯାଏ।

Literal meaning

Even if the dhinki goes to heaven, it will still pound paddy.

Meaning

The joke gives a rice-pounding implement a grand change of address but leaves its work exactly as before. In conversation, it can tease someone who brings an old habit into a new setting, or express frustration that a change of place has changed nothing. The pointed contrast is between heaven and the same everyday task.

An example · original

On a holiday, a friend immediately starts organising everyone's timetable just as at work. Another friend uses the saying with a laugh. (Original editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Dhinki is retained as the name of the traditional rice-pounding implement; paddy is rice still in its husk. Heaven supplies the exaggerated destination. This reading does not turn an implement's fixed function into a claim that people cannot change, or that anyone must remain in an inherited occupation.

Work & learning · Saying 061

କୁହାଯାଉଥାଇ ସିନା, ତୁହାଇ ତୁହାଇ ପୁଟ ଦେଲେ କାହିଁ, ଲୁହା କି ହୋଇବ ସୁନା

The wrong process cannot make gold

ଏକେ କାମ ବାରମ୍ବାର କଲେ ହିଁ ଆଶା କରିଥିବା ଫଳ ମିଳେନାହିଁ; ଉପାୟଟି ମଧ୍ୟ ଠିକ୍ ହେବା ଦରକାର|

Literal meaning

People may keep saying it, but will repeated firing turn iron into gold?

Meaning

Repeating a process does not ensure the transformation wanted. This editorial reading questions an unsuitable method, not anyone’s capacity to learn.

An example · original

Reformatting an inaccurate report cannot make its facts reliable. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

A metalworking image, not a claim of innate human rank or an instruction for processing metals.

Work & learning · Saying 093

ହାଟକୁ ଗଲେ କନ୍ୟା ଦେଖିବି ବାଇଗଣ ବିକିବି ଦି କାମ କରିବି

Two errands on one trip

ଗୋଟିଏ ଥର ଯିବାରେ ଦୁଇଟି କାମ ସାରିବାର ଯୋଜନା| କାମ ଦୁଇଟିର ଅଲଗା ସ୍ୱଭାବରେ ମଜା ଅଛି|

Literal meaning

At the market I will look for a bride and sell brinjals: I will do two tasks.

Meaning

One outing is made to serve two purposes. The unexpected pairing gives the plan its humour.

An example · original

Someone collects a repaired bicycle while returning a borrowed book nearby. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this under seeking. It does not establish a marriage custom or imply buying a bride.

Money & means · Saying 011

ଅଧର୍ମ ବିତ୍ତ ବଢେ ବହୁତ, ଗଲା ବେଳେ ଯାଏ ମୂଳ ସହିତ |

When dishonest gain takes the roots with it

ଅସତ୍ ଉପାୟରେ ଅର୍ଜିତ ଧନ ଶେଷରେ ସବୁ କିଛି ହରାଇବାର କାରଣ ହୋଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Wrongfully gained wealth grows greatly, but disappears with its roots.

Meaning

The image contrasts rapid growth with loss at the root. Wealth obtained dishonestly may look impressive, yet the conduct behind it can endanger the whole household or enterprise. This is a moral warning about how gain is obtained, not a reliable prediction that every dishonest person will become poor.

An example · original

A trader is tempted to falsify weights for a little extra profit. An older colleague uses the saying to warn that losing customers' trust could destroy the business. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The rhyme of ବହୁତ and ସହିତ gives the warning a memorable close. The root image suggests losing the foundation, not merely the most recent gain. A version appears as the opening proverb of the1893 collection.

Money & means · Saying 015

ଅରଜି ନପାରେ ମୁଣ୍ଡ, ସୁଆଦ ଲୋଡୁଚି ତୁଣ୍ଡ |

An appetite larger than the means

ସାମର୍ଥ୍ୟ ବା ଉଦ୍ୟମ ସହ ମେଳ ନ ଥିବା ବିଳାସର ଆଶା କରିବା|

Literal meaning

The head cannot earn; the mouth wants delicacies.

Meaning

The line sets the head's inability to earn against the mouth's demand for tasty food. It can rebuke expectations of luxury that do not match available means or contribution. Its tone is sharp and can be hurtful when applied to someone whose circumstances are outside their control.

An example · original

A group has agreed to a modest outing, but one member insists on an expensive feast while refusing to contribute. Another uses the saying to question that mismatch. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

ମୁଣ୍ଡ and ତୁଣ୍ଡ create a compact rhyme between earning and appetite. A possible related line in the1893 scan remains unverified; its uncertain wording is not presented here as a confirmed historical match.

Money & means · Saying 016

ଅଳପ ଧନ ବିକଳ ମନ

When means are short

ଅଭାବରେ ଆବଶ୍ୟକତା ପୂରଣ ନ ହେଲେ ମନ ବ୍ୟାକୁଳ ହୁଏ|

Literal meaning

Little money, an anxious mind.

Meaning

The line connects limited means with the distress of being unable to meet needs. Its compact rhyme can express sympathy for someone trying to make a small sum cover many demands. It need not be read as an accusation of greed or a judgement about character.

An example · original

A family is weighing school expenses against a repair bill; someone uses the line to acknowledge the pressure. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source adds an explanation about being unable to obtain necessities. That explanatory parenthesis is kept outside the saying itself.

Money & means · Saying 024

ମୋତେ ନ ଅଣ୍ଟେ ମୁଁ ନେଇ କରି ସାଇରେ ବାଣ୍ଟେ

Giving beyond one’s means

ନିଜ ପାଇଁ ନିଅଣ୍ଟ ଥାଇ ଅନ୍ୟଙ୍କୁ ବାଣ୍ଟିବାର ବଡ଼ ପ୍ରତିଶ୍ରୁତି ଦେବା|

Literal meaning

It is not enough for me, yet I take it and distribute it around the neighbourhood.

Meaning

The speaker describes a mismatch between available means and a display of generosity. It can question a promise to provide for everyone when the giver has not secured enough to do so. Its irony concerns overextension; it need not belittle sharing during hardship.

An example · original

An organiser promises supplies to several groups before checking whether the stock covers even the first group. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The neighbourhood gives the boast an audience. This is an editorial reading of the recorded wording; the witness supplies no separate explanation for this item.

Money & means · Saying 052

କାନ୍ଦୁଥା ଯାହା ପାଉଥିବୁ ବାନ୍ଧୁଥା ||

Complaining while collecting

ମୁହଁରେ ଅଭିଯୋଗ ଟାଲିଥାଏ, ତଥାପି ଯାହା ମିଳେ ତାହା ଗ୍ରହଣ କରାଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

Keep crying; tie up whatever you receive.

Meaning

The complaint continues while the benefits are quietly gathered. Read as irony about dissatisfaction that does not prevent acceptance.

An example · original

A guest calls every gift inadequate but carefully packs them all to take home. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Tying things into a bundle supplies the image. This interpretation is editorial; the witness provides no gloss.

Money & means · Saying 070

କେଉଟ ଧରେ ମାଛ, ଖାଏ କଙ୍କଡ଼।

The catch and the meal differ

ଯାହା ନିଜେ ଯୋଗାଉଛି, ସେହି ଜିନିଷ ନିଜ ଭାଗରେ ପଡୁନାହିଁ—କାମ ଓ ନିଜ ଅବସ୍ଥାର ତଫାତ ଏଠି ଦେଖାଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

The Keuta catches fish but eats crab.

Meaning

The contrast suggests that producing something does not ensure enjoying it oneself. The line can point to a gap between someone's work and their own circumstances.

An example · original

A carpenter makes fine cabinets for customers while keeping a broken cupboard at home. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Editorial reading of an unglossed line. Keuta is retained from the witness; this is not evidence about a community's diet, poverty or food preferences.

Money & means · Saying 075

ରଜା ପୁଅକୁ କି ଖଜା ଅପୂର୍ବ?

No rare treat for a prince

ଯାହା ଜଣକ ପାଇଁ ଦୁର୍ଲଭ, ସେହି ଜିନିଷ ଅନ୍ୟ ଜଣଙ୍କ ପାଖରେ ସହଜରେ ମିଳୁଥାଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Is khaja an extraordinary treat for a king’s son?

Meaning

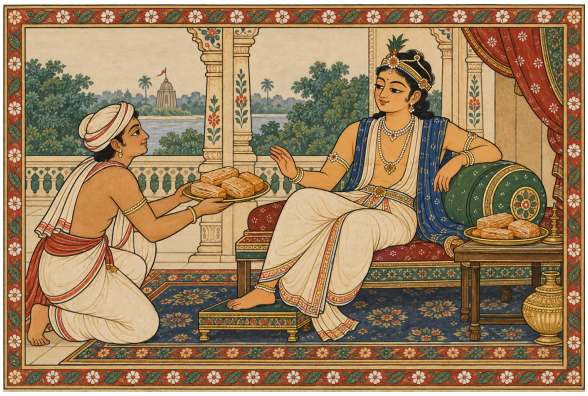
Something impressive to one person may be ordinary to someone with easy access. The rhetorical question puts the proposed treat in perspective.

An example · original

An experienced photographer is unlikely to be dazzled simply by being shown a camera. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Khaja remains the named sweet. The source gloss explains ready access; no particular prince or court incident is identified.



Original Pattachitra-inspired modern interpretation for Project Odisha; not archival or attributed to a traditional artist. A modern interpretation of the saying’s royal figure and sweet, not a documented historical scene. CC BY-SA4.0.

Money & means · Saying 079

ରଜାପୁଅ ସଙ୍ଗେ ଶୁଖୁଆବଣିଜ ବାଇ

Trading alongside a prince

ନିଜ ସାମର୍ଥ୍ୟଠାରୁ ବହୁତ ଅଧିକ ସାମର୍ଥ୍ୟ ଥିବା ଲୋକଙ୍କ ସହ ମାତିଲେ ନିଜେ ଅସୁବିଧାରେ ପଡ଼ିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

The folly of dried-fish trading with a prince.

Meaning

A person with fewer resources can suffer by joining someone whose means are much greater. The warning concerns an unequal undertaking.

An example · original

Friends plan an expensive outing without noticing that one cannot afford the shared costs. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

This follows the dictionary gloss; it is not a documented trading incident or a rule against friendships across income levels.

Money & means · Saying 094

ମହର୍ଘରୁ ଯାଇ କାନ୍ତାରରେ ପଡ଼ିବା

From scarcity into famine

ଗୋଟିଏ ଅସୁବିଧାରୁ ମୁକୁଳିବାକୁ ଯାଇ ଆହୁରି ବଡ଼ ଅସୁବିଧାରେ ପଡ଼ିବା| ଏଠାରେ କାନ୍ତାରର ଅର୍ଥ ଦୁର୍ଭିକ୍ଷ|

Literal meaning

To go from high prices into famine.

Meaning

A change meant to escape difficulty leads into something worse. Here କାନ୍ତାର is the dictionary's famine sense, not its separate forest sense.

An example · original

A shop changes to a cheaper supplier, then loses more because deliveries repeatedly fail. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The food-scarcity image supplies the comparison; no particular famine or historical event is identified.

Money & means · Saying 097

ବସିଖାଇଲେ ନଈବାଲି ସରେ

Even river sand runs out

ଭଣ୍ଡାର ଯେତେ ବଡ଼ ହେଲେ ବି କେବଳ ଖର୍ଚ୍ଚ କରି ଚାଲିଲେ ତାହା ସରିଯାଏ| ଭରଣା ନହେଲେ ନଈର ବାଲି ପରି ପ୍ରଚୁର ଜିନିଷ ବି ଶେଷ ହେବ ବୋଲି କୁହାଯାଇଛି|

Literal meaning

If one sits and consumes, even the river's sand runs out.

Meaning

Even a large store can be exhausted if it is continually used without replenishment. The exaggerated sand image makes the scale of the reserve irrelevant.

An example · original

A club repeatedly pays expenses from its reserve but collects no new contributions. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source places this under consuming savings without earning. It should not be used to blame people unable to work or to deny their need for support.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 010

ଝିମିଟି ଖେଳରୁ ମହାଭାରତ

A little game, an enormous quarrel

ସାମାନ୍ୟ କଥାରୁ ବଡ଼ ଝଗଡ଼ା ହେବା|

Literal meaning

From a game of jhimiti to the Mahabharata.

Meaning

A small disagreement grows into an outsized conflict. The Mahabharata provides a culturally recognisable scale of conflict. The expression is not evidence that the epic war literally began with this named game, and the game's precise historical rules have not been established here.

An example · original

Two friends disagree over a turn in a game; soon several families are arguing. A neighbour uses the saying to describe how far the quarrel has grown. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

ଝିମିଟି is retained rather than replaced by an invented modern game. The contrast is between a modest starting point and epic-scale escalation.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 019

ଆସିଲ ବନ୍ଧୁ ଭଲ କଲ, ବସିବାକୁ ନାହିଁ ଠା, ଯେଉଁ ବାଟେ ବାଟେ ଆସିଲ ବନ୍ଧୁ ସେଇ ବାଟେ ବାଟେ ଯା |

A welcome that sends you away

ମୁହଁରେ ସ୍ୱାଗତ କରି କାମରେ ଅନାଦର କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Good of you to come, friend; there is nowhere to sit. Go back by the very way you came.

Meaning

The opening sounds hospitable, but the ending cancels the welcome. The humour lies in that sudden reversal: someone offers warm words while making it plain that the visitor is unwanted. Used pointedly, it exposes courtesy that provides no actual welcome.

An example · original

A club warmly invites suggestions but immediately dismisses every visitor’s proposal; an observer recalls this saying. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The repeated address to a friend sharpens the irony. The example extends that verbal pattern to another setting; no historical hospitality custom is being asserted.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 026

ଏ ଘର ମାଉସୀ ସେ ଘର ପିଉସୀ

Making oneself welcome on every side

ଦୁଇ ପକ୍ଷରେ ଭଲ ହେବାକୁ ଯାଇ ଏପଟ କଥା ସେପଟ କରି ମନୋମାଳିନ୍ୟ ସୃଷ୍ଟି କରିବା|

Literal meaning

A maternal aunt in this house, a paternal aunt in that one.

Meaning

The expression portrays someone claiming closeness everywhere while carrying damaging talk between people. The source gloss stresses pleasing both sides and creating discord. Its target is manipulative familiarity, not genuine friendship across households.

An example · original

A neighbour tells each household that they alone have her sympathy, while repeating complaints from the other. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

ମାଉସୀ and ପିଉସୀ are distinct kinship terms, preserved in the literal rendering. The figurative criticism does not describe a trait of actual aunts or of women generally.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 033

ମାଲୋ ମଲି, ଗାଁ ଚାରିଆଡ଼େ ବୁଲି ଆଇଲି... କେହି ନକହିଲେ ବସ ବୋଲି...!!!

No one even asked me to sit

ସବୁଆଡ଼େ ଯାଇ ମଧ୍ୟ ସାମାନ୍ୟ ଆଦର ନ ମିଳିବାର ଦୁଃଖ ପ୍ରକାଶ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Oh mother, I am undone! I went all around the village; no one said, “Sit down.”

Meaning

The complaint turns a small invitation into the measure of being welcomed. After going everywhere, the speaker has not received even that acknowledgement. The exaggerated opening can make the hurt comic, while the last line reveals the modest courtesy that was missing.

An example · original

A visitor calls on several acquaintances and feels brushed aside by all of them, then recounts the experience with this lament. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source places it under a gloss about not receiving due respect. The dramatic ମଲି is rendered as an exclamation, not a report of death. No universal village hospitality rule is inferred.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 045

ଗାଁ କନିଆଁ ସିଂଘାଣି ନାକୀ

Familiarity that hides someone’s worth

ନିଜ ଆଖପାଖର ଚିହ୍ନା ଲୋକଙ୍କ ଗୁଣକୁ ମୂଲ୍ୟ ନ ଦେଇ ତାଙ୍କୁ ତୁଚ୍ଛ ଭାବିବା|

Literal meaning

The village bride is called runny-nosed.

Meaning

People who have known someone from everyday village life may dismiss that person instead of recognizing their qualities. The belittling description makes that dismissiveness audible. The saying can challenge a narrow local judgment without endorsing the insult directed at the bride.

An example · original

A skilled local storyteller receives appreciation elsewhere while neighbours still speak only of childhood mistakes. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The literal image is gendered and dismissive. The editorial reading concerns undervaluing the familiar; neither a universal village custom nor the saying’s first historical use is known.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 053

ଗଙ୍ଗା ବୋଇଲେ ଥିବି ଗାଙ୍ଗୀ ବୋଇଲେ ଯିବି

The name makes the difference

ସମ୍ବୋଧନ ଟିକେ ବଦଳିଲେ ମାନ ଭାଙ୍ଗିଯାଏ; ନିଜ ପସନ୍ଦର ଡାକକୁ ଏତେ ଗୁରୁତ୍ୱ ଦେବାକୁ ଏଠି ଚିଡ଼ାଯାଉଛି|

Literal meaning

Call me Ganga and I will stay; call me Gangi and I will leave.

Meaning

A change in address changes the reception. The contrast can tease someone who insists on a particular form of respect.

An example · original

An invited speaker accepts a formal introduction but objects to a familiar nickname. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Ganga and Gangi are retained as names; no real woman or originating incident is identified.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 057

ପଞ୍ଚମୂଳେ ପରମେଶ୍ୱର

Wisdom in consultation

ମିଳିମିଶି ବିଚାର କରିବାକୁ ଏହି କଥା ଗୁରୁତ୍ୱ ଦିଏ; ଦଳ ଯାହା କହିବ ତାହା ସବୁବେଳେ ଠିକ୍ ବୋଲି ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

At the gathering of the five is the Supreme Lord.

Meaning

The religious image gives weight to people deliberating together. It can encourage consultation rather than a decision made alone; it does not guarantee a group is right.

An example · original

Before changing a shared courtyard, neighbours sit together to hear one another’s needs. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this under five people gathered to discuss a subject. It is not the differently worded source127 position15.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 062

ଭାସି ଯାଉଥିଲୁ ମଝିନଇରେ ଧରି ଆଣିଥିଲି ତତେ, ଠାକୁଆ ଗାଲରେ ମାଉଁଶ ଲାଗିଲା ଜବାବ ଦେଉଛୁ ମତେ

Remembering a rescue

ବିପଦରେ ସାହାଯ୍ୟ ପାଇ ଅବସ୍ଥା ସୁଧୁରିବା ପରେ ସେହି ସାହାଯ୍ୟକାରୀଙ୍କୁ ଜବାବ ଦେବା ନେଇ ବକ୍ତା ଅଭିମାନ କରୁଛନ୍ତି।

Literal meaning

I pulled you from the river; now your hollow cheeks have filled out and you answer me back.

Meaning

The speaker resents defiance from someone previously helped. The rescue creates the contrast between former dependence and present confidence.

An example · original

A mentor complains when a former trainee openly challenges a decision. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Editorial interpretation of an unglossed witness. Receiving help does not remove a person’s right to disagree.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 072

ଛାଡ଼ ଅଞ୍ଚଳ ମହାବାହୁ... ଏ ଜନ୍ମେ ଭେଟ ନାହିଁ ଆଉ...!!!

A dramatic farewell

ଦୁଃଖ ସହି ନପାରି ବିଦାୟ ନେବାର ଭାବକୁ ଆଉ କେବେ ଭେଟ ହେବନାହିଁ ବୋଲି ତୀବ୍ର କରାଯାଇଛି|

Literal meaning

Let go of my garment’s end, mighty-armed one; in this life we shall meet no more.

Meaning

The source places this farewell under distress that feels unbearable. Its absolute language gives the parting a dramatic finality.

An example · original

A performer uses the line to portray a wounded character’s farewell; the scene is newly imagined. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The witness names no underlying song or episode. Mahabahu is rendered literally; no particular speaker or deity is assigned.

ଘର ଦେଖି ଦେଇ କି, ବର ଦେଖି ଦେଇ

The household or the groom?

ବିବାହ ବେଳେ ପରିବାରର ପରିଚୟକୁ ଦେଖାଯାଉଛି, ନା ବରକୁ ନିଜେ—ଏହି ଦୁଇ ମାନଦଣ୍ଡର ତଫାତ ଏଠି ଉଠିଛି|

Literal meaning

Is the marriage arranged by looking at the household, or at the groom?

Meaning

The question contrasts a family's standing with the individual being considered for marriage. It exposes two different ways of judging a match.

An example · original

A discussion of a prospective marriage dwells on the family name while saying little about the person. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places ଘର under high family. That records a status-conscious setting, not an endorsement of inherited rank; the saying does not establish either person's consent.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 092

ଦେଖିଲେ କଥା ନ କହେ, ନ ଦେଖିଲେ ପାଣି ନ ପିଏ

Silent together, restless apart

ସାମ୍ନାରେ ଦେଖିଲେ କଥା ନାହିଁ, ନଦେଖିଲେ ମନ ଥୟ ନାହିଁ—ଏହି ବିରୋଧାଭାସକୁ କଥାଟି ଧରିଛି|

Literal meaning

On meeting, says nothing; without seeing, will not drink water.

Meaning

The contradiction is the joke: someone seems distant in person but cannot settle when the other is absent.

An example · original

Two friends barely speak during a visit, then immediately ask when they will meet again. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source labels this ଢଗ under meeting. It names no relationship or reason for the silence.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 103

ଦେଶକେ ଫାଙ୍କ୍, ନଈକେ ବାଙ୍କ୍

Each place has its own ways

ସବୁ ଅଞ୍ଚଳର ରୀତି ଏକା ପରି ନୁହେଁ। ନଈର ବାଙ୍କ ପରି ପ୍ରତ୍ୟେକ ସ୍ଥାନର ନିଜସ୍ୱ ଢଙ୍ଗ ଅଛି। ନୂଆ ସ୍ଥାନର ଚଳଣି ବୁଝିବାକୁ ଏହି କଥା ମନେ ପକାଏ।

Literal meaning

Each place has its particular ways; each river has its bends.

Meaning

A way of doing things that feels ordinary in one place may differ elsewhere. The river image makes local variation easy to picture. The saying invites attention to the place you are in, without declaring every local practice beyond question.

An example · original

A visitor notices that a neighbouring village arranges its shared meal differently and asks how the local arrangement works. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The example appears under locality in the dictionary. A separate lexical entry gives particular and differing customs among the senses of ଫାଙ୍କ that supports the reading used here.

Relationships & belonging · Saying 104

ଏକା ହାତରେ ତାଳି ବାଜେ ନାହିଁ

One hand cannot clap

କିଛି କାମ ପାଇଁ ଉଭୟ ପକ୍ଷର ସହଯୋଗ ଦରକାର| ଗୋଟିଏ ପକ୍ଷର ଚେଷ୍ଟାରେ ସବୁବେଳେ କାମ ହୁଏ ନାହିଁ| ତେବେ କାହାରି କ୍ଷତି ହେଲେ ଉଭୟ ପକ୍ଷ ସମାନ ଦୋଷୀ ବୋଲି ଏଥିରୁ ଧରିନେବା ଠିକ୍ ନୁହେଁ|

Literal meaning

A clap cannot sound with one hand alone.

Meaning

Some things require a response or a shared effort. The image of two palms meeting makes that dependence immediate. It can invite cooperation; it should not be used to assume that both sides bear equal blame for harm.

An example · original

One person proposes a shared reading group; the others must also make time for it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary explicitly labels this example a dhaga under clapping. The explanation here is editorial, not a recorded account of its first use.



One hand, then two: the image makes cooperation visible. Original illustration for Project Odisha · CC BY-SA 4.0.

Fairness & power · Saying 012

ଆଲୋ ସଖି, ଆପଣା ମହତ ଆପେ ରଖି

Keeping one’s own dignity

ନିଜ ଆଚରଣରେ ନିଜ ସମ୍ମାନ ରଖିବା।

Literal meaning

Friend, preserve your own dignity yourself.

Meaning

The friendly address makes this advice sound like one person speaking directly to another: preserve your dignity through your own conduct. It may counsel restraint when someone is tempted to join a humiliating quarrel or chase approval. It does not make a person responsible for mistreatment inflicted by others.

An example · original

During an argument, a friend is about to answer an insult with another insult. Someone close to them uses the line to encourage a calm withdrawal. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The contemporary witness begins ଆଲୋ ସଖିὀThe1893 scan appears to begin ଆରେ ସଖିὀthat difference is retained as a provisional historical reading. The wording does not establish who first used the saying or confine its advice to one gender.

Fairness & power · Saying 047

ଆଲୋ ମୁତୁରି ଶୋଇବା, ତୁ ମୁତୁରୀ କି ମୁଁ ମୁତୁରା ହେଂସ କାହିଁପାଇଁ ଧୋଇବା...!!!

Both share the fault

ଉତ୍ସରେ ଏହାକୁ ଦୁଇଜଣ ଏକା ଦୋଷ କରିଥିବା ପରିସ୍ଥିତି ସହ ଯୋଡ଼ାଯାଇଛି| ଉଭୟଙ୍କ ଦୋଷ ଥିବାରୁ ପରସ୍ପରକୁ ଛାଡ଼ ଦେବା ଏହାର ଏକ ସମ୍ଭାବ୍ୟ ବ୍ୟାଖ୍ୟା; ଉତ୍ସରେ ବିସ୍ତୃତ ଅର୍ଥ ଦିଆଯାଇନାହିଁ|

Literal meaning

Come, bed-wetter, let us sleep. Are you the bed-wetter, or am I? Why wash the mat?

Meaning

The licensed page places this crude joke in the situation of two people sharing the same fault. One possible reading is that their shared embarrassment lets both excuse leaving things as they are. The specific suggestion of mutual indulgence is an editorial interpretation; the witness does not supply a detailed explanation. This bodily image should not be used to shame someone with an actual condition.

An example · original

Two members who both missed a deadline agree not to mention either delay at the meeting. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The licensed witness has a substantially different word order from the discovery list. Its bodily and gendered forms are retained without smoothing them into that other version. Bed-wetting is a comic image here, not a moral judgment about an actual condition. The figurative explanation is an editorial interpretation, not a separately verified traditional gloss.

Fairness & power · Saying 050

ତେଲିଆ ମୁଣ୍ଡରେ ତେଲ

More oil for an already oiled head

ଯାହାର ଆଗରୁ ସୁବିଧା ଅଛି, ତାହାକୁ ହିଁ ଆଉ ଅଧିକ ସୁବିଧା ଦେବା| ଅନ୍ୟମାନଙ୍କ ଦରକାର ଅଣଦେଖା କରି ସେହି ଲୋକଙ୍କୁ ବାରମ୍ବାର ସାହାଯ୍ୟ ବା ଆଦର ଦେଲେ ଏହି କଥାରେ ଅସନ୍ତୋଷ ପ୍ରକାଶ କରାଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

Oil on an already oiled head.

Meaning

The extra oil goes where there is already oil. Used socially, the image questions giving still more attention, help or advantage to someone already well provided for, while others go without. It can sound wry or resentful, depending on who is speaking and how the benefit is being distributed.

An example · original

A well-equipped group receives another set of supplies while a neighbouring group still lacks the basics. Someone uses the saying to question the allocation. (Original editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The head and oil remain the material image; no named oiling ritual, caste practice or historical incident is implied. The emphasis here is advantage being added to advantage. Other conversational uses, including praise directed at powerful people, need their own context rather than being treated as the only meaning.

Fairness & power · Saying 059

ମାରିନେଲେ ମହାପାତ୍ରେ ଚାହିଚାହିଁ ଜଳକା |

Taken while you watched

ଚତୁର ଲୋକ ନିଜ କାମ ହାସଲ କରିନିଏ, ଆଉ ଜଣେ ଜଳକା ହୋଇ ଚାହିଁ ରହିଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

Mahapatra took it away; the onlooker could only stare, bewildered.

Meaning

A shrewd person gains the advantage while someone else watches helplessly. The bite lies in noticing the trick too late.

An example · original

A bidder secures the last stall while another is still trying to understand the rules. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Mahapatra is retained from the wording, not treated as evidence about a surname or community.

Fairness & power · Saying 066

କାଣୀ ବିରାଡ଼ି କୁଜି ଅସରପା ଉପରେ ରଜା

Power over someone weaker

ନିଜେ ବହୁତ ଶକ୍ତିଶାଳୀ ନହେଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ଆହୁରି ଦୁର୍ବଳ ଜଣଙ୍କ ଉପରେ ରୋବ ଦେଖାଇବା|

Literal meaning

The one-eyed cat is king over the bent-backed cockroach.

Meaning

Even a limited power can dominate a weaker opponent. The contrast makes that small kingdom look less impressive.

An example · original

A minor official who cannot influence a decision intimidates a visitor who needs help. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Editorial reading: the source gloss repeats the line. Its bodily caricatures are retained for documentation, not endorsed as measures of human worth.

Fairness & power · Saying 076

ରଜାର ପ୍ରଜା ନୁହେଁ କି ସାହୁର ଖାତକ ନୁହେଁ

Beholden to neither

କାହାର ଅଧୀନରେ ବା ଋଣରେ ନରହି ସ୍ୱାଧୀନ ଭାବରେ ଚଳିବାର ଭାବ ଏଠି ପ୍ରକାଶ ପାଏ|

Literal meaning

Neither the king’s subject nor the moneylender’s debtor.

Meaning

The speaker presents themself as independent and free of debt. It is a forceful refusal to be treated as someone under another’s control.

An example · original

A self-supporting craftsperson rejects a patron’s attempt to dictate a personal decision. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary gloss supports independence and absence of debt. This is figurative self-assertion, not a legal exemption from obligations.

Fairness & power · Saying 086

କଥାର ମଞ୍ଜି, କୁଆ ଧାନ ଖାଏ ବୋହୁକୁ ଗଞ୍ଜି

The crow eats; someone else is blamed

ଦୋଷ କରୁଛି ଜଣେ, ଗାଳି ଶୁଣୁଛି ଆଉ ଜଣେ। ପ୍ରକୃତ କାରଣ ନଦେଖି ଅନ୍ୟ ଉପରେ ଦୋଷ ଲଦିବାର ଅନ୍ୟାୟ ଏଥିରେ ଧରାପଡ଼େ।

Literal meaning

The kernel of the matter: the crow eats the paddy, but the daughter-in-law is scolded.

Meaning

Blame falls on someone other than the one responsible. The contrast exposes how unfair that is.

An example · original

A shared file disappears because of a system fault, but a new colleague is blamed before anyone checks. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The household scene names a daughter-in-law as the target of blame. It is not a claim about every family or an endorsement of blaming women.

ହାତରେ ନ ମାରି ଭାତରେ ମାରିବି

A threat against someone’s food

ହାତ ଉଠାଇବା ବଦଳରେ ଖାଇବା ବା ଚଳିବାର ସାହାଯ୍ୟ ବନ୍ଦ କରି କଷ୍ଟ ଦେବାର ଧମକ ଏହା|

Literal meaning

I will hurt you through your rice, not with my hand.

Meaning

The threat is to deprive someone of food or support rather than strike them. It exposes another form of coercion.

An example · original

Someone withholds promised support to punish disagreement; another person identifies the threat. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Recorded as a saying, not advice or justification for deprivation.

Fairness & power · Saying 090

ଝିଅକୁ ମାରି ବୋହୂକୁ ଶିଖାଇବା

Punishing one to warn another

ଦଣ୍ଡ ଜଣଙ୍କୁ ଦିଆଯାଉଛି, କିନ୍ତୁ ଭୟ ଦେଖାଇବା ବା ସତର୍କ କରିବାର ଲକ୍ଷ୍ୟ ଆଉ ଜଣେ|

Literal meaning

Beat the daughter to teach the daughter-in-law.

Meaning

One person is punished so that someone else takes the warning. The indirect target is the point of the saying.

An example · original

A supervisor publicly rebukes one person while looking at another who made the same mistake. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The household image contains violence against women. Recording it does not endorse that violence or claim every family behaves this way.

Fairness & power · Saying 096

ଝିଣ୍ଟିକା ମାରି ବଣି ପୋଷିବା ନ୍ୟାୟ

Feeding one at another’s expense

ଜଣକର କ୍ଷତି କରି ଅନ୍ୟ ଜଣକର ଲାଭ କରାଇବା| ଝିଣ୍ଟିକା ମରେ, ବଣି ଖାଇ ବଞ୍ଚେ—ଏହି ବିପରୀତ ଫଳ ହିଁ କଥାଟିର ମୂଳ|

Literal meaning

Like killing grasshoppers to feed a myna.

Meaning

The image exposes a benefit obtained by making another bear the loss. The explanation follows the contrast between the creature killed and the one nourished.

An example · original

A manager improves one team’s figures by shifting its unfinished work onto another team. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary labels the expression ପ୍ରବଚନ⁰Its linked insect and bird entries support the literal image; the social application is editorial.

Fairness & power · Saying 100

ଅଣ୍ଟି ଛୁରି ତଣ୍ଟି କାଟେ

Harm from what was kept close

ଯାହାକୁ ନିଜର ବୋଲି ଭରସା କରି ପାଖରେ ରଖିଥାଉ, ସେହିଠାରୁ କ୍ଷତି ହେବା। ଏଠାରେ ଛୁରିର ଚିତ୍ରଟି ବିଶ୍ୱାସଭଙ୍ଗକୁ ବୁଝାଏ।

Literal meaning

The knife tucked at the waist cuts the throat.

Meaning

Something or someone trusted and kept close becomes the source of harm. The dictionary puts the saying beside its figurative sense of cheating.

An example · original

A trusted business partner secretly diverts the shop’s receipts. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Violent imagery describes betrayal; it is not an instruction to harm anyone. The source does not establish a particular origin story.

Feelings & the self · Saying 001

ଅତି ଲେମ୍ବୁ ଚିପୁଡ଼ିଲେ ପିତା |

Squeezing past the useful point

ଅତି କଲେ ଭଲ କାମର ଫଳ ମଧ୍ୟ ଖରାପ ହୋଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

If you squeeze a lemon too much, it turns bitter.

Meaning

The useful action—extracting juice—becomes counterproductive when carried too far. The warning is about proportion: pressing for one more favour, one more concession or one more advantage may damage what was already achieved. It does not mean that effort itself is bad.

An example · original

After a neighbour has agreed to help for an afternoon, repeatedly asking for more time may invite this saying. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The image makes a social judgement through an ordinary kitchen action. This reading explains the metaphor; it is not a scientific claim about every citrus fruit or a documented account of how the proverb originated.



Original Pattachitra-inspired interpretation for Project Odisha, approved by the Founder; not an archival painting or a work attributed to a traditional artist. CC BY-SA4.0.

Feelings & the self · Saying 009

ଔଷଦ ରାଗରେ ଟାଟିଆ କାମୁଡିବା

Anger aimed at the bowl

ଯାହା ପାଇଁ ରାଗ, ତାହା ବଦଳରେ ଅନ୍ୟ ଉପରେ ରାଗ ସୁଝାଇବା|

Literal meaning

Biting the bowl in anger at the medicine.

Meaning

The unpleasant thing is the medicine, but the anger is directed at its container. The expression describes displaced frustration: attacking a messenger, object or bystander instead of addressing the actual problem.

An example · original

A delayed delivery frustrates a customer, who shouts at a neighbour merely passing on the update. Another person uses the saying to identify the misplaced anger. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source writes ଔଷଦ and କାମୁଡିବା ଏthis edition preserves those forms rather than silently replacing them with modern spellings. The image explains behaviour and gives no advice about taking medicine.

Feelings & the self · Saying 021

ଖସ କୁଣ୍ଡାଇ ଘା କରିବା

Making a small irritation worse

ଛୋଟ ଅସୁବିଧାକୁ ଅଯଥା ଖୋଚି ବଡ଼ ସମସ୍ୟା କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Scratch an itch into a wound.

Meaning

An action that brings brief relief can deepen the original trouble. In conversation, the expression can describe reopening a minor grievance until it becomes a serious quarrel. The rebuke is directed at aggravating the problem rather than resolving it.

An example · original

A small misunderstanding has been settled, but repeated sarcastic reminders start the argument again. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The bodily image supplies a social metaphor. This entry explains that metaphor and offers no medical advice.

ଅଜାଗା ଘା ଦେଖି ହୁଏ ନାହିଁ କି ଦେଖାଇ ହୁଏ ନାହିଁ |

A difficulty too awkward to disclose

ଏପରି ଅସୁବିଧାରେ ପଡ଼ିବା, ଯାହା ନିଜେ ସମ୍ଭାଳିବା କଷ୍ଟ ଓ ଅନ୍ୟକୁ କହିବାକୁ ସଙ୍କୋଚ ଲାଗେ|

Literal meaning

A sore in an awkward place can neither be seen nor shown.

Meaning

The image conveys a predicament that is hard to inspect privately and embarrassing to disclose. In conversation, it can express the burden of a trouble someone feels unable to explain openly. Its force lies in that double bind, rather than in a recommendation to keep suffering secret.

An example · original

A person asked to mediate a dispute between close relatives feels unable to describe either side's private complaints. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The bodily image is retained in the literal rendering. The figurative explanation is an editorial reading; no medical claim or origin incident is established.

Feelings & the self · Saying 030

କାହାକୁ କହିବା, କପାଳରେ ସିନା କର ମାରିବା

Who is there to tell?

ଅଭିଯୋଗ ଶୁଣିବାକୁ କେହି ନାହାନ୍ତି ବୋଲି ମନେ କରି ବିରକ୍ତି ପ୍ରକାଶ କରିବା|

Literal meaning

Whom can one tell? One can only strike a hand against one’s forehead.

Meaning

This is a gesture of exasperation put into words. The speaker feels that complaining will find no useful listener, so frustration turns into a weary reaction. It may be rueful or comic; it expresses a feeling of helplessness without proving that help is unavailable.

An example · original

After correcting the same simple mistake several times, a person says this with a tired laugh. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

କର means hand here. The literal gesture helps convey the expression; no physical action is prescribed by the explanation.

Feelings & the self · Saying 031

ମୋତେ ଯେତେ ମାଠିବୁ ମାଠ ମୁହିଁ ସେଇ ଦରପଡ଼ା କାଠ

Refusing to be polished into something else

ଯେତେ ବୁଝାଇଲେ ବା ବଦଳାଇବାକୁ ଚେଷ୍ଟା କଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ନିଜେ ସେପରି ରହିବି ବୋଲି କହିବା|

Literal meaning

Polish me as much as you like; I remain that half-burnt wood.

Meaning

The speaker declares that repeated efforts to change or improve them will not work. The blunt material image can make the refusal comic, defiant or self-deprecating. It voices a stance in a conversation, not a truth that people cannot learn or change.

An example · original

After repeated advice to adopt a more fashionable manner, someone jokingly insists that they will remain as they are. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The wood image and the first-person voice are preserved. This is distinct from enduring pressure: here the emphasis falls on resisting another person's attempts to remake the speaker. The source spells the word ଦରପଡ଼ାଠ“Half-burnt” is an editorial interpretation of that spelling, not a verified correction to the original; lexical and human review remain pending.

Feelings & the self · Saying 032

ତୁ କେତେ ହଲଉଚୁ ହଲା... ମୁଁ କିଛି ନହଲିଲେ ଗଲା...!!!

You can shake; I need not move

ଅନ୍ୟେ ଯେତେ ଚାପ ଦେଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ନିଜ ସ୍ଥିରତା ରଖିବା|

Literal meaning

Shake as much as you like; it is enough if I do not budge.

Meaning

The speaker answers pressure with a challenge. Another person may keep trying to unsettle them, but the speaker claims control over their own response. The tone can convey resolve or stubbornness; its value depends on what they are refusing to yield about.

An example · original

Friends tease someone to abandon a carefully considered decision; the reply insists that the teasing will not change it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source introduces these lines as a response by someone determined. That introductory gloss is excluded from the headword. The digital ellipses and exclamation marks are retained, not claimed as ancient punctuation.

Feelings & the self · Saying 034

କ୍ଷୀର ଉତୁରିଲେ ଚୁଲିକୁ, ମଣିଷ ଉତୁରିଲେ ଗାତକୁ...!!!

Pride that boils over

ଅତ୍ୟଧିକ ଗର୍ବ କଲେ ନିଜର ପତନ ହୋଇପାରେ|

Literal meaning

When milk boils over, it spills onto the hearth; when a person goes too far, into the pit.

Meaning

The first line supplies an everyday overflow; the second turns it into a warning about arrogance. The source explicitly frames the saying as a response to excessive pride. Its sharp downward ending suggests that losing restraint can bring a fall.

An example · original

A successful team member begins dismissing everyone else's advice, and a colleague warns against letting success become arrogance. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The comparison is between two kinds of overstepping. It is a figurative warning, not a prediction that every proud person will suffer a particular fate. The source's digital punctuation is preserved.

Feelings & the self · Saying 040

ଆରେ ଢମଣା , ବୁଲି ବୁଲିକରି ସେଇ ଅଗଣା |

Back to the same courtyard

ବହୁତ ବୁଲାବୁଲି ବା ଚେଷ୍ଟା ପରେ ପୁଣି ପୂର୍ବ ସ୍ଥାନ ବା ଅବସ୍ଥାକୁ ଫେରିଆସିବା|

Literal meaning

Hey, dhamana, after all that wandering, you are back in the same courtyard.

Meaning

A wandering journey ends where it began. In conversation, the image can describe repeated detours that bring no change, or someone returning to a familiar place after trying alternatives. The tone may be teasing or critical, depending on the situation.

An example · original

After considering several meeting places, the group chooses its usual courtyard again. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The creature-name dhamana is retained without assigning a precise species. The courtyard supplies the image of return; no belief about animal behaviour or local origin is established.

Feelings & the self · Saying 044

ଘଇତା ପଛେ ମରୁ କିନ୍ତୁ ସଉତୁଣି ରାଣ୍ଡ ହେଉ!.

Resentment that harms oneself

ଅନ୍ୟର କ୍ଷତି ହେବ ବୋଲି ଜାଣିଶୁଣି ନିଜର ମଧ୍ୟ କ୍ଷତି ଚାହିଁବା—ପ୍ରତିଶୋଧରେ ନିଜ ହିତ ଭୁଲିଯିବା|

Literal meaning

Let my husband die, so long as the co-wife becomes a widow.

Meaning

Spite becomes so strong that the speaker accepts a shared loss merely to hurt a rival. The deliberately harsh domestic scene exposes the cost of that desire. It is a criticism of destructive resentment, not a claim that women or co-wives naturally behave this way.

An example · original

Two groups refuse a shared resource because each would rather lose access than let the other benefit. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source preserves a coarse term for widow and a co-wife rivalry image. Those gendered insults are part of the documented wording, not language the explanation endorses or a history of any particular household. The figurative explanation is an editorial interpretation, not a separately verified traditional gloss.

Feelings & the self · Saying 063

ରାଧା କହିଲେ ଦୂତୀ କି, ଯାହା ହେଇଟି ସେତିକି...!!!

What has happened has happened

କଥା ହାତରୁ ଖସିଗଲେ ଯାହା ଘଟିଛି ତାହାକୁ ମାନିନେବାର ଭାବ ଏଠି ରହିଛି|

Literal meaning

Radha told the messenger: what has happened is that much.

Meaning

A resigned response when events have become difficult to contain: further words cannot undo what has occurred.

An example · original

After an announcement has already gone out, arguing over the unsent draft no longer changes it. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The source invokes Radha and a female messenger but names no underlying poem or episode; none is supplied here.

Feelings & the self · Saying 067

ଅଖ ବୁଲୁଥିଲେ ଚକ ବୁଲୁଥାଏ, ବୁଲି ପଡୁଥାଏ ମହି, ସଂସାର ଭିତରେ ଘର କରିଥିଲେ ପଥର ପଡ଼ିଲେ ସହି |

Living with the jolts

ସଂସାରରେ ରହିଲେ ସୁଖ ସହ ଦୁଃଖ ମଧ ଆସେ; ବିପଦରେ ଧୈର୍ଯ୍ୟ ଧରିବାକୁ ଏହି କଥା କହେ|

Literal meaning

The axle turns, the wheel turns, the earth turns; having made a home in the world, endure even falling stones.

Meaning

The movement of ordinary life leads into counsel to withstand hardship. Endurance is the proposed response to unavoidable jolts.

An example · original

After a storm delays a harvest, a family steadies itself and plans the remaining work. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Editorial interpretation of an unglossed verse. Endurance does not require accepting abuse or preventable harm.

Feelings & the self · Saying 068

ଗୋଦରୀ ଲଲା ଗୋଡ଼କୁ ଅନା

Look at your own feet

ଅନ୍ୟର ଦୋଷ ଧରିବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ ନିଜ ଅସୁବିଧା ଓ ଦୋଷକୁ ମଧ୍ୟ ଦେଖିବା ଦରକାର।

Literal meaning

Woman with swollen legs, look at your own feet.

Meaning

A sharp retort turns scrutiny back on the critic: examine your own shortcomings before mocking someone else's.

An example · original

Someone criticises a neighbour's untidy records while their own paperwork is in disarray. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The body-directed insult is part of the historical-style wording, not a recommended way to address illness or disability. Meaning is an editorial reading.

Feelings & the self · Saying 069

ଗଂଗାଦି ନାନା ତୀର୍ଥ ନିକଟେ ଥାଇଣ ଚାତକ, ଜଳଦ ଜଳ ଟୋପେକୁ ଆଶ୍ରାକରି ଅବିରତେ ତୃଷୀକ

Waiting for one particular drop

ପାଖରେ ଅନ୍ୟ ସୁଯୋଗ ଥିଲେ ବି ମନ ଗୋଟିଏ ଆଶାରେ ଅଟକି ରହେ; ପ୍ରସଙ୍ଗ ଅନୁସାରେ ଏହା ନିଷ୍ଠା ବା ଅବ୍ୟବହାରିକ ଅପେକ୍ଷା ଲାଗିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

Near the Ganga and other sacred waters, the chataka remains thirsty, depending on a drop from a cloud.

Meaning

The verse pictures longing fixed on one source despite alternatives nearby. It may evoke steadfast desire; context determines whether that seems admirable or impractical.

An example · original

A musician declines several engagements while waiting for the invitation that matters most to them. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

Read as a literary bird-image, not a claim about a species' drinking habits. The page names no author or originating work.

Feelings & the self · Saying 071

ମାଗି ଖାଉଥାଏ ବାସି ତୋଡ଼ାଣି, ଯାଚିଲେ ନ ଖାଏ ସର ଲବଣୀ

Refusing what is freely offered

ମାଗି ସାଧାରଣ ଜିନିଷ ନେଉଥିବା ଲୋକ ଯାଚିଦେଲେ ଭଲ ଜିନିଷକୁ ମଧ୍ୟ ନେବାକୁ ମନା କରିବା—ଏହି ବିରୋଧାଭାସକୁ କଥାଟି ଚିଡ଼ାଏ|

Literal meaning

They ask for stale rice-water to eat, yet refuse cream and butter when offered.

Meaning

The contrast mocks a refusal that appears at odds with what someone usually seeks. An unsolicited offer is rejected despite being presented as more desirable.

An example · original

Someone repeatedly asks to borrow basic tools but declines a better set freely offered by a neighbour. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary explicitly labels this a dhaga under offering something. Rice-water interprets the witness spelling ତୋଡ଼ାଣି without changing it. The saying does not explain why the offer is refused; consent and personal preference remain valid.

Feelings & the self · Saying 073

ବଣ ପୋଡ଼ିଲେ ଦୁନିଆ ଜାଣେ, ମନ ପୋଡ଼ିଲେ କେହୀ ନ ଜାଣେ

The fire nobody sees

ବାହାରର ବିପଦ ସମସ୍ତଙ୍କୁ ଦେଖାଯାଏ, କିନ୍ତୁ ମନର ଦୁଃଖ ଅନ୍ୟଙ୍କ ଅଗୋଚରରେ ରହିପାରେ|

Literal meaning

When a forest burns, the world knows; when the heart burns, no one knows.

Meaning

Visible calamity draws attention; private grief can remain unnoticed. The contrast asks the listener to recognise pain that has no outward blaze.

An example · original

A neighbour appears composed at work while privately grieving a loss. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary places this under mental distress. “No one” is the saying’s emphatic contrast, not a claim that support is impossible.



Original Pattachitra-inspired modern interpretation for Project Odisha; not archival or attributed to a traditional artist. Visible fire and private grief are set beside each other as an interpretation of the saying. CC BY-SA4.0.

Feelings & the self · Saying 084

ଅଳପ ନିଦକୁ ବହୁତ କଥା, ଝୁରିମରିବାକୁ କଲା ବିଧାତା

Little rest, many troubles

ବିଶ୍ରାମ ଅଳ୍ପ, ହେଲେ ଚିନ୍ତା ଓ ଘଟଣାର ଶେଷ ନାହିଁ—ଏମିତି କ୍ଲାନ୍ତିର ଅଭିଯୋଗ ଏଠାରେ ଶୁଣାଯାଏ|

Literal meaning

Little sleep, so much happening; fate has made me pine away.

Meaning

A weary complaint that troubles leave little rest. The exaggerated lament carries the feeling of being overwhelmed.

An example · original

After several demanding days, someone sighs that even bedtime brings another worry. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary cites this under happening/event. This is an editorial reading of its lament, not sleep advice.

Feelings & the self · Saying 105

ଗତସ୍ୟ ଶୋଚନା ନାସ୍ତି

What is past cannot be undone

ଯାହା ଘଟିସାରିଛି ଓ ଫେରାଇ ହେବ ନାହିଁ, ତାହାକୁ ନେଇ କେବଳ ଅନୁତାପରେ ଅଟକି ନରହିବା| ଶିଖିବା ଓ ଆଗର କାମ କରିବାକୁ ମନ ଦେବା|

Literal meaning

No lamentation for what has gone.

Meaning

The maxim urges someone to stop dwelling on an irreversible event and attend to what can still be done. It need not mean forgetting lessons or dismissing grief.

An example · original

After missing an application deadline, someone prepares carefully for the next opportunity. (New editorial example, not a collected quotation.)

In context

The dictionary explicitly labels this a Sanskrit proverb recorded in Odia. It is not a rule about how long someone should grieve.

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